



Fig.1: An overview of the difference in screen size made by increase in resolution

(Figs 2 and 3 compare how text appears in lower and higher resolutions.)

**Battery.** Battery life is an important factor to consider. Tablets use mostly lithium-polymer or lithium-ion batteries. A tablet's battery backup technically depends upon a lot of chips that go in it. Read the battery specifications provided by the manufacturer.

However, there are certain things you can keep in mind while handling your tablet to ensure that it has a good battery life:

1. Exit an application when it's not in use
2. Set a timer for the screen lock so that the tablet's screen goes in sleep mode when not in use



Fig.2: Screen with smaller resolution



Fig.3: Screen with larger resolution

## Tablet innovations at CES 2012

- Fujitsu's tablet can be fully submerged in water for up to 30 minutes without any damage
- Lenovo's tablet can be converted into a laptop with double the battery life
- Toshiba's Excite is a 1.7cm (0.67-inch) thin tablet coated with anti-smudge surface

3. Switch off the Bluetooth when not in use

4. Keep the screen brightness low

5. Disable 3G when not required

6. Disable the automatic Wi-Fi search option when there is no connectivity to Wi-Fi

**Touchscreen sensitivity.** Touchscreen sensitivity can make or break your entire tablet experience. Most tablets use capacitive touchscreens. These were introduced in the mainstream by iPhone and offer multi-touch capabilities. The 'pinch and zoom' is made possible due to the capacitive digitiser.

Unlike resistive digitisers, which work with pressure, capacitive digitisers sense skin contact by the touching action. These touchscreens can thus not be used for handwriting on the screen, unless a special stylus is used that makes the digitiser take the input as a touch of the skin. One can write ink notes on an iPhone with certain applications (when used with the stylus).

**Compatibility.** Tablets are best to work with 3G (or 4G) connection for faster browsing. Also, there is no point missing on some of the best capabilities of the tablet like video calling, with a 2G connection.

**Storage.** With a wide array of applications running, the tablet needs to have a good storage capac-

ity. In most tablets, the storage medium is a solid state device (SSD). Tablets come in various storage capacities and many a times the price varies with different storage capacities among the same model. Map your requirement and also look for availability of storage expansion options such as micro SSD.

**Support for call function.** Many tablets can also make a phone call. Look for one if you really don't wish to carry two gadgets in your pocket. A tablet in hand with calling facility is worth two gadgets in your pocket.

**Camera.** Some tablets have a single camera, some have a dual-camera (one front-facing), while there might be some tablets without any camera. The best option would be to go for one with dual-camera. One of the important reasons is that it will allow voice chat. Also, check the camera resolution.

**Features.** After comparing the different tablets in terms of basic features and functions, check their specific features as well. There are various features, which vary with different tablets. For example, iPad cannot play Flash videos. BlackBerry PlayBook on the other hand does not have native e-mail support. It has to be configured with the BlackBerry phone for the same.

## What's in the offing?

With technology advancing, new trends are hitting the tablet space every day. The *Consumer Electronics Show 2012* witnessed tablets with 3D and Super AMOLED displays as well as tablets that run Ice Cream Sandwich. There were even water-proof tablets on display. Single- and dual-core processor tablets have ruled the market for quite some time, but now tablets with quad-core processors are making inroads. These would offer better performance and therefore better battery backup as well.

Though quad-core tablets have not been officially launched across the globe, these will be up for grabs in no time. ●

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